# Phraseology

## CM 2 : Fixation, Defixation and Refixation

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1 Before we start...

2 Fixation, Defixation, Refixation

3 Defixed Multiword Expressions

4 Defixed Multiword Expressions and NLP

What did you learn during last lecture ?
Any questions ?

# Last Lecture Doggy bag

## Multiword Expressions

- Studied in phraseology
- Several components
- Somewhat fixed
- Somewhat idiomatic
- Always conventionalized

## MWEs and NLP

- MWE discovery
- MWE identification



Last time, we studied MWEs, the objects of phraseology.

Today, we will study the phenomenoms related to these objects.

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# The Fixation Phenomenom

## () definition

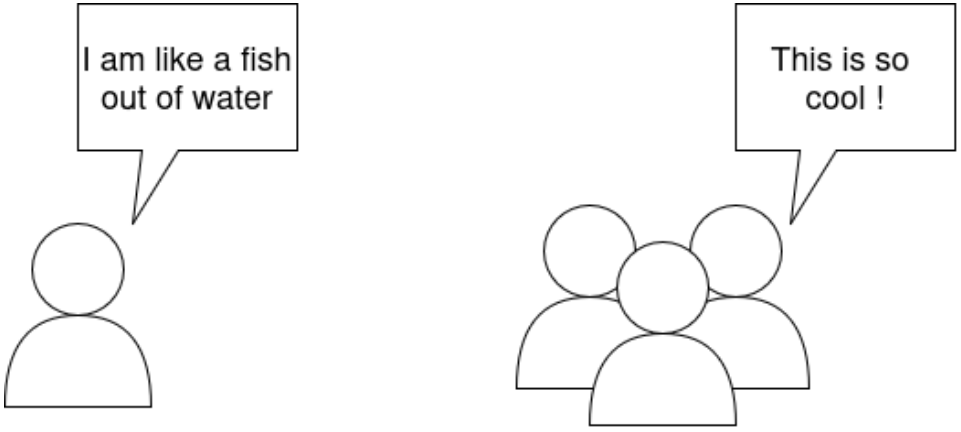
*"[Fixation] is a dynamic process that takes root in a language through usage and ultimately establishes sequences of all kinds in the lexicon"*[1]

## What is its purpose ?

- Helps us structure our speech with pre-fabricated sentences (MWEs)
- Allows us to easily memorize and use these sentences
- ⇒ Acts as a linguistic shortcut

[1] [Le figement] est processus dynamique qui s'installe dans la langue grâce à l'usage et qui finit par fixer des séquences de toutes sortes dans le lexique

# How Does Fixation Happens ?




Just like that, a new expression was born.

## Some Fixation Examples

- (En) Killing two birds with one stone
- (Fr) Les chats ne font pas des chiens[2]
- (Pt) Nem aqui nem na China[3]

Fixation occur in every languages.
Fixation goes with conventionalization.

[2] Lit. "cats do not raise dogs"
[3] Lit. "not here and not in China"

# One More Fixation Example

## Bismillah c'est les ténèbres ![4]




[4] Bismillah it's darkness !

# The Defixation Phenomenom

## () definition

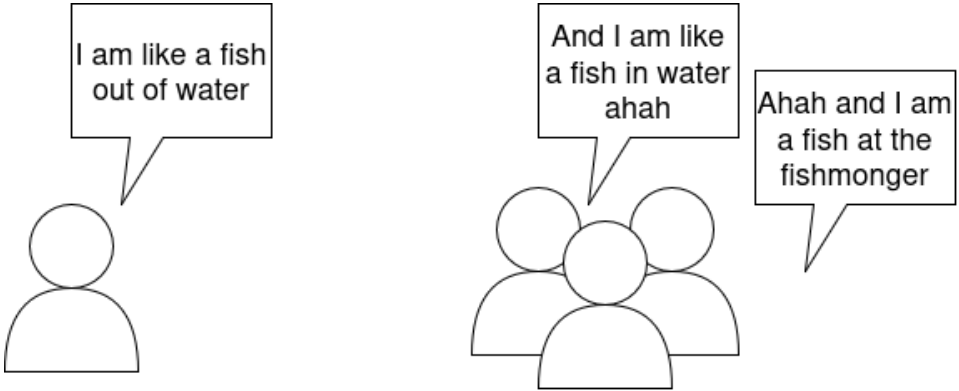
*"Any formal or semantical change made on a fixed sequence would be considered as a defixation."*[5]

## What is its purpose ?

- Activates the meaning of a MWE + a new meaning
- Often used to create satiric / humoristic sentences
- ⇒ As for fixation, acts as a linguistic shortcut

[5] toute atteinte à la fixité formelle et à la globalité sémantique d'une séquence figée serait considérée comme un défigement

# How Does Defixation Happens




We are just playing with an expression, what could happen ?

## Some Defixation Examples

- Revenge of the Vegans
- Lord of the Wings
- Requiem for a Drunk
- Silence of the Lamborghini
- Fifty Shades of Sharks

Fixation is not limited to sayings and locutions.
Pop-culture sentences and citations can become MWEs too.

# More Defixation Examples

## Bismillah c'est les ténèbres ![6]




[6] Bismillah it's darkness !

# The Refixation Phenomenom

## () definition

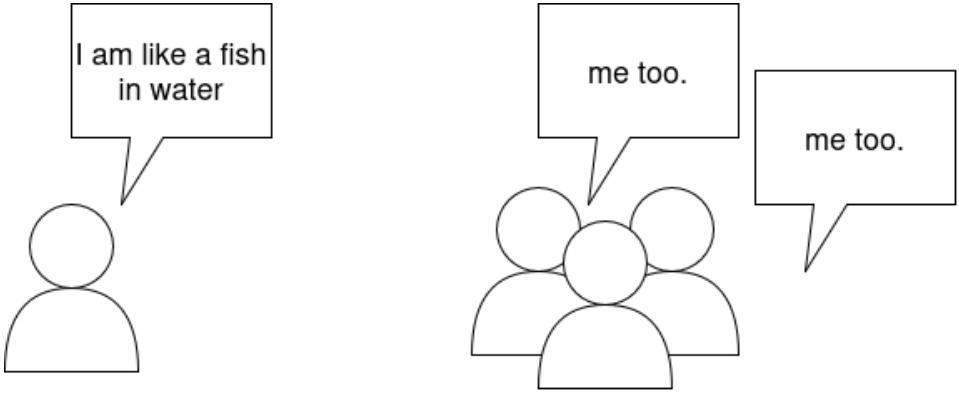
*"Refixation can be defined as the acceptation of a new form or meaning for a given MWE, which can be more or less close to the original one."*[7]

## What is its purpose ?

- Allows older expression to be relevant again
- Acknowledges new entries within a language's lexicon
- Can either replace the original MWE or become a new MWE

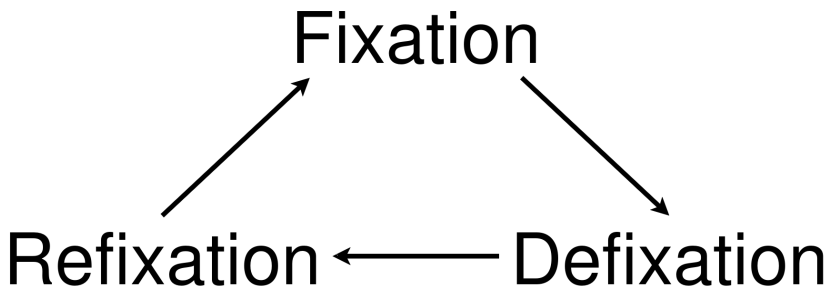
[7] le refigement peut être défini comme l'acceptation d'une nouvelle forme d'une EMM, plus ou moins éloignée de sa forme originelle.

# How does Refixation Happens ?




Oh no, it's everywhere now !

## The Whole Process



# To Summarize

## Fixation - A sequence becomes a MWE

- To be like a fish out of water

## Defixation - A MWE is used to create a variant of itself

- To be like a fish in the aquarium
- To be like a fish at the fishmonger
- **To be like a fish in the water**

## Refixation - A MWE variant becomes a MWE

- To be like a fish in the water

MWEs can undergo this process over and over again.

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# How to Identify a Defixed MWE ?

## Properties

- Always based on an existing MWE
- Caracterized by a formal and/or semantical change
- Use their context to add new meaning
- Can be recognized by the locutors of a given language

## Examples

- May the **Fourth** be with you
- It's raining **nems**

# Exercise Time !

Take a look at the following sequences

- Orange is the new pink
- Orange is the new grey
- Pink is the new black
- Gen-z is the new sans-culottes

What do they have in common ?

# Exercise Time !

Take a look at the following sequences

- Orange is the new pink
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What do they have in common ?
A patern ⇒ X is the new Y

# Defixed MWEs are hard to Define

## Most of the time, defixation follows a patern ()

- X is the new Y
- In space, no one can hear you X
- The X, the Y and the Z

## But a MWE can be defixed through other means

- Orange is the old black
- Orange is not the new black
- The current President of the US is definitely not the new Gandhi

Where is the limit between a defixation and a lambda sequence ?

## How to Deal with Defixed MWEs

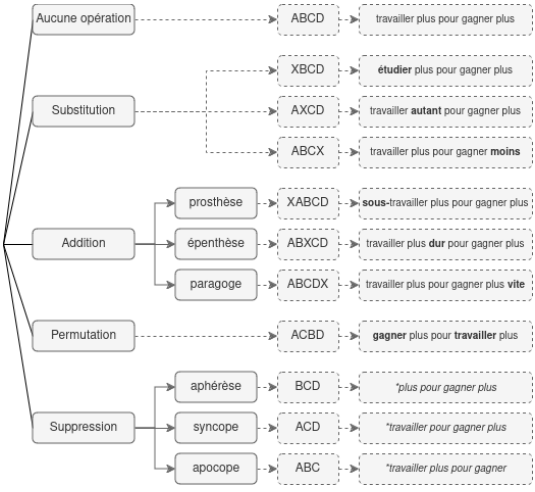
Where is the limit between a defixation and a lambda sequence ?

We lack both data and analysis !

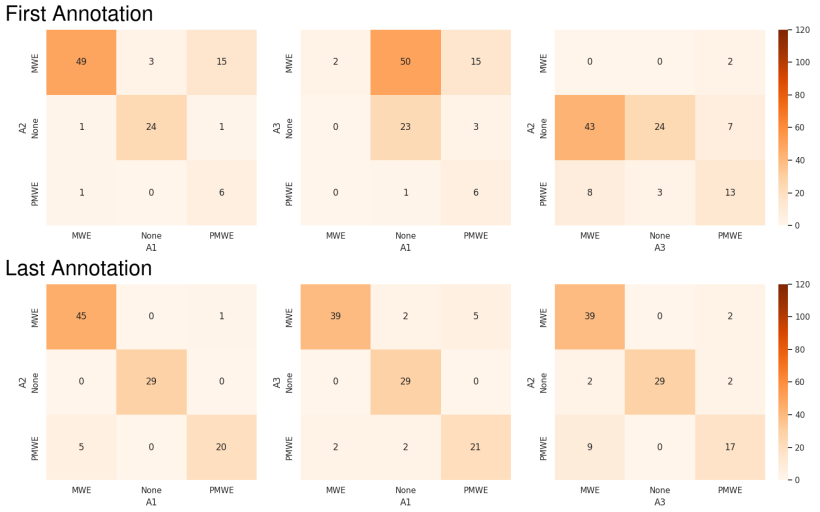
### The current solution

- **Step 1:** identify sequences which may correspond to defixed MWEs
- **Step 2:** filter these sequences to only retain defixed MWEs

# Step 1: Typology of Transformations ()



# Step 2: Human Annotation and Dialogue



# Common Locks and Issues

## A lambda sequence is too close to a MWE

- Ubuntu 26.10 is the new update
- j'en peux plus de travailler plus

## The defixation is not formal

- La fin du Monde
- Une toile de maître

## A defixed MWE is too different from the MWE

- Trump was not the new Ghandi

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## Exercise Time !

How would you process defixed MWEs in NLP ?

# Doggy bag

## Linguistic Phenomenoms

- Fixation
- Defixation
- Refixation

## Defixed MWEs

- Properties
- Locks and issues
- How to process them

